

23STCV19836 23STCV19836

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 310

Hearing date: 2026-06-25

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Case Number: 23STCV19836 Hearing Date: June 25, 2026 Dept: 310

Tentative Ruling

Judge Kevin C. Brazile

Department 310

Hearing Date: June 25, 2026

Case Name: Navarrete v. Manhattan Loft, LLC, et al.

Case No.: 23STCV19836

Matter: Motion to Bifurcate

Moving Party: SBDTLA 1, LLC, SBDTLA 2, LLC, SBDTLA 3, LLC, and SBDTLA 4,

LLC and GREYSTAR CALIFORNIA, INC

Responding Party: Stephanie Navarrete

Notice: OK

Ruling: The Motion is granted only as to punitive damages.

Moving party to give notice.

The Court encourages all parties to appear remotely via LA CourtConnect. If submitting on the Court's tentative ruling, please follow the instructions provided above.

This is a habitability matter.

Defendants SBDTLA 1, LLC, SBDTLA 2, LLC, SBDTLA 3, LLC, and SBDTLA 4, LLC and GREYSTAR CALIFORNIA, INC. seek to bifurcate the issues of liability and damages. They also seek to bifurcate the issue of financial condition for the purposes of punitive damages.

“Whether separate actions shall be consolidated for trial, or whether there shall be a severance and separate trials of issues in a single action, is within the discretion of the trial court.” (Mellone v. Lewis (1965) 233 Cal.App.2d 4, 7, quoting McArther v. Shaffer (1943) 59 Cal.App.2d 724, 727.) The objectives of bifurcated trials are to “expedite and simplify the presentation of evidence” (Foreman & Clark Corp. v. Fallon (1971) 3 Cal.3d 875, 888), and “avoidance of the waste of time and money caused by the unnecessary trial of damage questions in cases where the liability issue was resolved against the plaintiff.” (Plaza Tulare v. Tradewell Stores, Inc. (1989) 207 Cal.App.3d 522, 524.)

Defendants failed to show the convenience of bifurcation for liability and damages issues.

The Motion is granted only as to bifurcating financial condition for the purposes of punitive damages. (Civ. Code § 3295(d).)

Moving party to give notice.